ETCSL 1.8.1.4 — Gilgameš, Enkidu and the nether world (Bilgames and the Netherworld)

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- **Editors:** ETCSL project (J. Black, G. Cunningham, E. Robson, G. Zólyomi), Oxford 1998–2006; composite after Civil 1989 and Krecher 1996 (electronic), score George 1998; the XML header lists **Shaffer 1963** (PhD, Pennsylvania: composite, commentary, copies), Römer 1986, Tournay and Shaffer 1994, George 1999 (*The Epic of Gilgamesh*, Penguin, 175–195), **Cavigneaux and Al-Rawi 2000** (the Me-Turan tablets: score, translation, photographs), Gadd and Shaffer, UET 6 (the Urim versions).
- **URLs:** transliteration https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=c.1.8.1.4 ; translation https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.1.8.1.4 ; ORACC epsd2/literary **Q000364** (lemmatised, with morph: `../../ORACC/epsd2-literary--Q000364--Gilgamesh-Enkidu-and-the-Netherworld/`).
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-21 from the local OTA 2518 bulk corpus (`../_bulk/etcsl.zip`, members `etcsl/transliterations/c.1.8.1.4.xml`, `etcsl/translations/t.1.8.1.4.xml`).
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Content

Five recensions in ETCSL's order:

1. **Version A** (Nibru, Urim and elsewhere): lines 1–303 with the pluses 152A, 163A, 287A–D, 293A–B; ETCSL has no lines 280–285 (a gap). The prologue (creation, the division of heaven, earth and netherworld; Enki's voyage, 1–26); the *ḫalub* tree, Inana's garden, the snake, the Anzud bird and the *ki-sikil-lil$_2$-la$_2$* (27–135); Bilgames fells the tree and makes the *ellaĝ* and *ekidma* (ball and mallet) (136–171); they fall into the netherworld (172–176); Enkidu's descent, Bilgames's instructions and their breach (177–242); the appeals to Enlil, Enki and Utu; Enkidu's shade comes up (243–252); the interrogation: the fates of the dead by their lives (253–303). Lines 172–303 = the Akkadian **Gilgameš XII** 1–153 (a translation of the Sumerian), already translated in `../../../אפוס-גילגמש/`.
2. **A version from Urim, UET 6 58** (28 lines): a different order of the interrogation.
3. **Another version from Urim, UET 6 59** (segments A 9 and B 11).

4. **A third version from Urim, UET 6 60** (17 lines): Bilgames's return to Unug, the statues of the dead, the libations ("my father and my mother, drink clear water"), the doxology.
5. **A version from Me-Turan** (segments A 24 and B ~71, after Cavigneaux and Al-Rawi 2000): the interrogation in another order, with new fates (the stillborn, the man burnt to death, the leper …).

Files

- `c.1.8.1.4.xml`, `t.1.8.1.4.xml` — ETCSL TEI source.
- `transliteration.md`, `translation.md` (ETCSL's English prose by paragraph) — `../../../tools/etcsl2md.py`.

Line numbering

ETCSL composite numbers (Shaffer 1963's for Version A; the literature cites them). The other versions are numbered per tablet, with segment letters. ORACC Q000364 has the same lines, labelled `Ver.1, N` for Version A (a few lines unlabelled: aligned by position in `העולם-התחתון/netherworld_tools.py`).

Usefulness

Base text (rank 1) for `העולם-התחתון/4-גילגמש-אנקידו-והעולם-התחתון/`. The ETCSL translation is the rank-3 check; George 1999 and Gilgameš XII (the ancient Akkadian translation) are the second check for 172–303.